6 Here are five straight rods.



All measurements are in centimetres.

The total length of the five rods is L cm.

Find a formula for L in terms of a.
Write your formula as simply as possible.

$L = (a - 1) + a + a + a + (a + 4)$

1 mark
Add the five lengths

There are five a-terms; $-1 + 4 = 3$.

1 mark
Collect the like terms

$L = 5a + 3$

1 mark
Include L in the formula

$L = 5a + 3$

(Total for Question 6 is 3 marks)